

Word family: **personal / personally / personality / personalize / personalise / personalized / personalised / impersonal**

Base word: personal

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, with some noun uses in fixed contexts

Related forms:

* **personal** (adj.) — 個人的；私人的；親身的；針對個人的

* **personally** (adv.) — 就個人而言；親自地；私下地

* **personality** (n.) — 個性；人格；名人

* **personalize / personalise** (v.) — 個人化；按個人需要調整

* **personalized / personalised** (adj.) — 個人化的；度身訂造的

* **impersonal** (adj.) — 非個人的；欠人情味的；客觀冷淡的

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **personal information**

* **personal details**

* **personal belongings**

* **personal space**

* **personal life**

* **personal opinion**

* **personal experience**

* **personal choice**

* **personal responsibility**

* **personal assistant**

* **personal trainer**

* **personal best**

* **personal touch**

* **take something personally**

* **nothing personal**

* **personal attack**

* **personal question**

* **personalized service**

Meaning in this passage

> ...I was a bit nervous before she opened it, because it felt much more **personal** than the usual things I would buy.

Here, **personal** means:

**closely connected to the speaker's own feelings, memories, and relationship with his mother

— 很個人的；帶有私人感情的；有強烈個人色彩的**

The gift felt more emotionally revealing and intimate than an ordinary shop-bought present.

中文翻譯：

.....因為這份禮物比我平時買的東西**更個人化、更貼近彼此回憶，也更有私人感情**。

So here:

personal = 帶有自己私人感情、經歷或關係色彩，而不是一般或制式化的

1. **personal (個人的；屬於某人的) — 個人的**

Practice 1

> This is my **personal opinion**.

這是我的**個人意見**。

Practice 2

> Everyone has different **personal preferences**.

每個人都有不同的**個人喜好**。

Practice 3

> She made the decision for **personal reasons**.

她因為**個人原因**作出這個決定。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal = 與某一個人本身、其選擇、感受或情況有關的

2. **personal (私人的；不公開的) — 私人的；私隱的**

A major branch.

Practice 1

> That's **personal information**.

那是**私人資料**。

Practice 2

> He doesn't like discussing his **personal life** at work.

他不喜歡在工作場合談自己的**私人生活**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal = 屬於個人私隱、不希望公開給所有人知道的

3. **personal information / personal details — 個人資料**

Practice 1

> Never share your **personal information** with strangers online.

不要在網上向陌生人透露你的**個人資料**。

Practice 2

> Please enter your **personal details** below.

請在下面填寫你的**個人資料**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal information/details = 可用來識別、聯絡或描述某人的私人資料

4. **personal belongings — 私人物品**

Practice 1

> Please take all your **personal belongings** with you.

請帶走你所有的**私人物品**。

Practice 2

> Her **personal belongings** were kept in a locker.

她的**私人財物**放在儲物櫃裏。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal belongings = 屬於某個人自己的物品或財物****

5. ****personal space — 個人空間****

Practice 1

> Some people need more ****personal space**** than others.

有些人比其他需要更多****個人空間****。

Practice 2

> He stood too close and entered my ****personal space****.

他站得太近，侵犯了我的****個人空間****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal space = 一個人希望其他人保持距離、不隨意進入的身體周圍私人範圍****

6. ****personal life — 私生活****

Practice 1

> She keeps her ****personal life**** private.

她把自己的****私生活****保持低調。

Practice 2

> His work began to affect his ****personal life****.

他的工作開始影響他的****私人生活****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal life = 一個人在工作或公共身份以外的私人生活、關係和家庭狀況****

7. ****personal (帶有個人感情 / 個人色彩的) — 個人化的；有私人感情的****

This is closest to your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-related

> The handmade album felt much more **personal** than a shop-bought gift.

那本手工相簿比商店買的禮物感覺**更有個人感情 / 更貼心**。

Practice 2

> She wrote a **personal message** inside the card.

她在卡裏寫了一段**很有個人感情的訊息**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal = 帶有某人的私人感情、回憶、關係或獨特心意

8. **personal message / letter** — 私人訊息；親筆心意

Practice 1

> He added a **personal message** to the gift.

他在禮物中加了一段**私人而有心意的留言**。

Practice 2

> She sent me a **personal letter**.

她寄給我一封**私人信件**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal message/letter = 直接寫給某個人、內容具有私人或感情色彩的訊息 / 信件

9. **personal touch** — 個人特色；貼心的人情味

A very useful expression.

Practice 1

> The handwritten note added a **personal touch**.

手寫紙條增添了**個人特色和人情味**。

Practice 2

> Small hotels often offer a more **personal touch**.

小型酒店通常更有**貼心的人情味**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal touch = 令某事顯得更有人情味、更貼近個人需要或更具獨特心意的小細節

10. **personal (親身的 ; 本人的) — 親自的 ; 本人直接的**

Practice 1

> This is based on my **personal experience**.

這是根據我的**親身經歷**。

Practice 2

> She gave me a **personal account** of what happened.

她向我作了**親身敘述**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal = 某人自己親自經歷、觀察或接觸過的

11. **personal experience — 親身經驗**

Practice 1

> I know this from **personal experience**.

我從**親身經驗**知道這一點。

Practice 2

> Her advice comes from **personal experience**.

她的建議來自**親身經歷**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal experience = 自己親自經歷過的事情，而不是從別人那裏聽來的****

12. ****personal opinion / view — 個人意見 / 看法****

Practice 1

> In my ****personal opinion****, the simpler design is better.

就我的****個人意見****而言，較簡單的設計更好。

Practice 2

> That's only his ****personal view****.

那只是他的****個人看法****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal opinion/view = 某人自己主觀持有的看法****

13. ****personal choice — 個人選擇****

Practice 1

> What you wear is a ****personal choice****.

穿甚麼是你的****個人選擇****。

Practice 2

> Diet is often a matter of ****personal choice****.

飲食往往是****個人選擇****的問題。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal choice = 由個人根據自己偏好作出的決定****

14. ****personal responsibility — 個人責任****

Practice 1

> Everyone has a **personal responsibility** to follow the rules.

每個人都有遵守規則的**個人責任**。

Practice 2

> He accepted **personal responsibility** for the mistake.

他承擔了這次錯誤的**個人責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal responsibility = 某個人自己需要承擔的責任，而不是由群體或他人承擔

15. **personal** (針對某人的) — 針對個人的

This can be neutral or negative depending on context.

Practice 1

> The criticism became **personal**.

批評開始變成**針對個人**。

Practice 2

> Try not to make the argument **personal**.

盡量不要把爭論變成**人身針對**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal = 把焦點放在某個人的性格、外貌或私人事情，而不是事情本身

16. **personal attack** — 人身攻擊

Practice 1

> The debate turned into a **personal attack**.

辯論演變成**人身攻擊**。

Practice 2

> Criticize the idea, not the person; avoid **personal attacks**.

可以批評觀點，但不要批評人本身；避免**人身攻擊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal attack = 針對某人的**人格、外貌或私人特徵**作出攻擊，而不是討論其觀點或行為

17. **personal question** — 私人問題；涉及私隱的問題

Practice 1

> Can I ask you a **personal question**?

我可以問你一個**私人問題**嗎？

Practice 2

> She felt uncomfortable answering such a **personal question**.

她不太舒服回答這麼**私人的問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal question = 涉及私人生活、關係、收入、感情等敏感個人事情的問題

18. **take something personally** — 把某事當成針對自己

A major idiom.

Practice 1

> Don't **take it personally**.

不要**覺得那是在針對你**。

Practice 2

> She **took the criticism personally**.

她把那些批評**當成對自己個人的攻擊**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****take something personally = 把某句話或某個行為理解成針對自己個人，因而感到受傷或冒犯****

19. ****nothing personal — 不是針對你；沒有私人恩怨****

Practice 1

> It's ****nothing personal****; we just chose another candidate.

這****不是針對你本人****；我們只是選了另一位候選人。

Practice 2

> Don't worry—it's ****nothing personal****.

別擔心，這****不是私人恩怨****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****nothing personal = 某個決定或批評不是因為對某人有私人敵意或成見****

20. ****personally (就我個人而言) — 就我而言；我個人認為****

Practice 1

> ****Personally****, I prefer the handmade gift.

****就我個人而言****，我較喜歡手工禮物。

Practice 2

> I ****personally**** think the idea is practical.

****我個人認為****這個想法很實際。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personally = 表示以下內容是說話者自己的看法，而不是客觀事實或群體意見****

21. ****personally (親自地) — 親自****

A distinct adverb sense.

Practice 1

> The manager ****personally**** thanked every employee.

經理****親自****感謝每一位員工。

Practice 2

> I will ****personally**** deliver the gift.

我會****親自****把禮物送過去。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personally = 由本人直接去做，而不是叫別人代做****

22. ****personally (私下認識) — 私交上；本人認識****

Practice 1

> I don't know her ****personally****.

我****私下並不認識她本人****。

Practice 2

> Have you ever met him ****personally****?

你有沒有****親自見過 / 私下認識****他？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****know someone personally = 與某人有直接私人接觸，而不是只知道對方是誰****

23. ****personal assistant — 私人助理 / 行政助理****

Practice 1

> She works as a ****personal assistant**** to the director.

她擔任董事的****私人助理****。

Practice 2

> His **personal assistant** manages his schedule.

他的**私人助理**負責管理日程。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal assistant = 直接協助某個人的日程、行政和日常工作的人

24. **personal trainer** — 私人健身教練

Practice 1

> He works with a **personal trainer** twice a week.

他每星期跟**私人健身教練**訓練兩次。

Practice 2

> A **personal trainer** designed a programme for her.

一位**私人健身教練**為她設計了訓練計劃。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal trainer = 為個別客戶提供一對一健身指導和訓練計劃的教練

25. **personal best** — 個人最佳成績

A sports/performance sense.

Practice 1

> She ran a **personal best** in the 100 metres.

她在 100 米跑出了**個人最佳成績**。

Practice 2

> His time was a new **personal best**.

他的時間創下新的**個人最佳紀錄**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal best = 某個人自己歷來最好的成績，而不是與其他人比較的排名

26. **personalized / personalised** — 個人化的；度身訂造的

Practice 1

> The website offers **personalized recommendations**.

網站提供**個人化推薦**。

Practice 2

> She ordered a **personalized gift** with her mother's name on it.

她訂了一份印有媽媽名字的**個人化禮物**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personalized = 根據某個人的名字、偏好、需要或資料特別製作或調整的

27. **personalize / personalise** — 使個人化

Practice 1

> You can **personalize the card** with a message.

你可以加上訊息，把卡片**個人化**。

Practice 2

> The app **personalizes** content for each user.

這個應用程式會為每位用戶**個人化內容**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personalize = 根據個人的資料、名字、喜好或需要作出調整

28. **personality** (個性；性格) — 個性；性格

A major family extension, but semantically distinct enough to teach separately.

Practice 1

> She has a warm **personality**.

她有很溫暖的**性格**。

Practice 2

> His quiet **personality** is very different from his brother's.

他安靜的**個性**和哥哥很不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

personality = 一個人較持久的性格特徵、行為方式和待人風格

29. **personality** (名人；知名人物) — 知名人物；名人

A media sense.

Practice 1

> She became a well-known television **personality**.

她成為一位知名的電視**名人 / 主持人物**。

Practice 2

> Several media **personalities** attended the event.

多位媒體**名人**出席了活動。

MCQ-ready definition:

personality = 因電視、電台、網絡或娛樂事業而廣為人知的人物

30. **impersonal** — 非個人的；欠人情味的

Practice 1

> The email sounded cold and **impersonal**.

那封電郵聽起來很冷淡、**欠人情味**。

Practice 2

> Large hotels can sometimes feel **impersonal**.

大型酒店有時會令人覺得**欠缺個人關懷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

impersonal = 缺乏個人感情、個別關懷或人情味的

31. **impersonal** (非針對個人的 ; 客觀的) — 非個人的 ; 不涉及特定人士

Practice 1

> The rule is completely **impersonal**.

這條規則完全**不針對任何特定個人**。

Practice 2

> Academic writing often uses an **impersonal style**.

學術寫作常採用較**非個人化 / 客觀的文體**。

MCQ-ready definition:

impersonal = 不以特定個人的感情、身份或立場為中心的

Important distinction 1: **personal** vs **private**

personal

broader: connected with one individual.

private

specifically not public / restricted to oneself or selected people.

> personal opinion

> 個人意見

does not necessarily mean secret.

> private conversation

> 私人談話

means not intended for everyone.

So:

personal ≠ automatically confidential

Important distinction 2: **personal vs individual**

personal

often emphasizes one's own feelings, life, belongings, identity.

individual

emphasizes one person/unit rather than a group.

> personal feelings

個人感受

> individual students

個別學生

Important distinction 3: **personal vs personalized**

personal

belongs to or relates closely to a person.

personalized

has been specially changed or made for that person.

> a personal gift

很有私人心意的禮物

> a personalized gift

按收禮者特別訂製的禮物

This distinction is especially important for your passage.

The album is ****personal**** because of the memories and emotion. It may also be ****personalized**** because it was specifically made for the mother, but those are not identical ideas.

Important distinction 4: ****personal vs intimate****

****personal****

private or individual.

****intimate****

more deeply private, emotionally close, or sensitive.

Your passage's gift is very ****personal****, but ****intimate**** would sound stronger and could imply a more private emotional closeness.

Important distinction 5: ****personal vs emotional****

****personal****

connected to a specific person's own life or relationship.

****emotional****

connected to strong feelings.

A gift can be:

- * personal but not emotional
- * emotional but not personalized
- * both personal and emotional

Your album is both.

Important distinction 6: ****personal vs subjective****

****personal opinion****

one person's own view.

subjective judgment

based on personal feelings rather than objective criteria.

They overlap, but **subjective** specifically contrasts with **objective**.

Important distinction 7: **personal experience vs experience**

experience

can mean general accumulated knowledge.

personal experience

stresses that the speaker directly lived through it.

> From personal experience, I know how difficult it is.

= 我是親身經歷過的。

Important distinction 8: **personal question vs direct question**

personal question

asks about someone's private life.

direct question

asks something clearly and straightforwardly.

A direct question is not necessarily personal.

Important distinction 9: **personal attack vs criticism**

criticism

can target an idea, action, decision, performance.

personal attack

targets the person.

> Your argument is weak.

criticism of argument.

> You're stupid.

personal attack.

Important distinction 10: **take it personally vs be personally responsible**

These look similar but mean different things.

take it personally

feel that something is aimed at you.

be personally responsible

you yourself bear responsibility.

> Don't take it personally.

別覺得是在針對你。

> You are personally responsible.

你本人需要負責。

Important distinction 11: **personally = opinion vs personally = in person**

Opinion

> Personally, I disagree.

我個人認為不同意。

In person

> I personally delivered it.

我親自送去。

Same word, distinct adverb functions.

Important distinction 12: **personality vs character**

These overlap.

personality

how someone typically thinks, behaves, and interacts.

character

can refer more to moral qualities, inner nature, or a fictional person depending on context.

> outgoing personality

外向性格

> strong moral character

堅強的品格

Family-extension note

Personal has several strong modern branches:

1. **belonging/relating to one person**

- * personal opinion
- * personal choice
- * personal belongings

2. **private**

- * personal information
- * personal life
- * personal question

3. **emotionally individual / meaningful**

- * personal gift
- * personal message
- * personal touch

4. **first-hand**

- * personal experience
- * personal account

5. **directed at the person**

- * personal criticism
- * personal attack
- * take it personally

6. **service tailored to one person**

- * personal assistant
- * personal trainer
- * personalized service

7. **family extensions**

- * personally
- * personality
- * personalize
- * impersonal

For your passage, the strongest nuance is:

personal = emotionally specific to the relationship and shared memories, rather than generic

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
personal	個人的	related to one person	
personal information	個人資料	private identifying info	
personal belongings	私人物品	owned by person	
personal space	個人空間	physical boundary	

personal life	私生活	non-public life	
personal gift	有個人心意的禮物	emotionally individual	
personal message	私人 / 貼心訊息	direct personal content	
personal touch	人情味；個人特色	individualized detail	
personal experience	親身經驗	firsthand experience	
personal opinion	個人意見	own view	
personal choice	個人選擇	own decision	
personal responsibility	個人責任	responsibility borne personally	
personal attack	人身攻擊	attack on person	
personal question	私人問題	privacy-sensitive question	
take it personally	覺得被針對	interpret as personal	
nothing personal	不是針對你	no private hostility	
personally (opinion)	就我個人而言	own viewpoint	
personally (directly)	親自	in person	
personal assistant	私人助理	one-person support	
personal trainer	私人健身教練	one-to-one trainer	
personal best	個人最佳成績	own record	
personalized	個人化的	specially tailored	
personalize	使個人化	tailor to person	
personality	性格；個性	enduring traits	
personality (media)	名人	public figure	
impersonal	欠人情味的；非個人的	not individualized	

For your original sentence

> I was a bit nervous before she opened it, because it felt much more ****personal**** than the usual things I would buy.

Here:

****personal = 很有私人感情、貼近兩人共同回憶，而且帶有自己的心意****

It does ****not**** simply mean:

> 私人的 = secret/confidential

and it does ****not**** merely mean:

> personalized = specially customized

The point is that the album revealed something of the speaker's own feelings and their shared family history.

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 在她打開之前，我其實有點緊張，因為這份禮物比我平時買的東西**更有個人感情，也更貼近我們之間的共同回憶**。

For this passage, **「很個人化」** is possible, but **「很有個人感情 / 很有私人心意」** captures the emotional nuance more precisely.